PROJECT PULMONARY · CHAPTER GUIDE

Gear Decontamination Kits

How to fund, build and deliver post-call decon kits to your local stations

October 2026

At a glance

What: a clear pouch with decon wipes, contamination bags, gloves, a seat liner and a reference card

Cost: about $4.45 per kit, or $445 for 100 kits

Built at: volunteer sessions, alongside Letters for Lungs

Funded by: the main org, grants and local sponsors

Delivered: in person to stations, one kit per firefighter plus 10%

Overview

Chapters assemble and hand out small decontamination kits so firefighters can start cleaning off soot and toxins right after a call. Each kit is a clear toiletry-size bag with decon wipes, contamination bags, gloves, a seat liner and a laminated quick-reference card.

Saunas help the body clear toxins after exposure, and hydration drives support firefighters on the job. Neither one covers what stays behind on skin, gear, clothing and personal belongings once the call is over. These kits fill that gap for under $5 a kit.

The program runs on systems chapters already use: kits are built at volunteer sessions like Letters for Lungs, funded through sponsor pitches like Hydration Drive, and delivered to stations the same way.

The kit

Every kit is one clear zippered pouch, about toiletry-bag size, packed with the six items below. Clear bags let firefighters see what's inside and let stations check stock at a glance.

Item	Per kit	What it's for	Bulk price
Clear zippered pouch	1	Holds everything; stays in the gear bag or apparatus	$120 / 100
Carcinogen-removal wipes	4	Strip soot and VOCs (volatile organic compounds) off face, neck and hands before they absorb	$6–9 / 40–80
Contamination bags	2	Seal soot-covered items right away so they don't touch anything else	$19 / 40

Item	Per kit	What it's for	Bulk price
Nitrile gloves	2 pairs	Handle contaminated gear without spreading residue to skin	$9.50 / 100
Plastic seat liner (optional)	1	Keeps soot off vehicle seats if someone has to ride in contaminated clothing	$13 / 30
Laminated reference card	1	The four steps to take right after a call	Get a quote

Where to buy

- Clear zippered pouches (Bags in Bulk)
- Quickstop Decon Wipes (All Hands Fire)
- Husky 42 gal contractor bags (Walmart)
- MedPride nitrile gloves, medium (Walmart)
- XUKEY disposable seat covers (Walmart)
- Reference cards: local print shop, or print and laminate as a chapter

Packing notes

- Fold contractor bags flat and tight so the pouch still zips. If they don't fit, switch to a smaller heavy-duty bag (13–30 gal).
- Order gloves in M and L. Mark the size on the outside of the pouch with a sticker.
- Drop the seat liner if the pilot budget is tight. It is the first item to cut.

Quick-reference card text

Print double-sided, about 3.5 × 2 in (business-card size), so it fits flat in the pouch.

> **FRONT: RIGHT AFTER THE CALL**
>
> 1. Rinse or wipe exposed skin now: face, neck, hands.
> 2. Bag your gear before it touches anything else.
> 3. Shower within the hour.
> 4. Wash gear separately from other laundry.
>
> **BACK**
>
> Project Pulmonary logo, chapter name, and a contact line for restocking.

Budget

A 100-kit order costs about $445 with seat liners, or about $395 without. Use that number in grant and sponsor asks, plus a 10% buffer for shipping and tax (about $490 total).

The order sheet below is what to actually buy for 100 kits. Wipes are priced at the high end ($9 per 40) so the budget holds if the cheaper pack is out of stock.

Item	Units needed	Packs to buy	Cost	Per kit
Clear pouches	100	1 × 100	$120	$1.20
Decon wipes	400	10 × 40	$90	$0.90
Contamination bags	200	5 × 40	$95	$0.95
Nitrile gloves	400 (200 pairs)	4 × 100	$38	$0.38
Seat liners (optional)	100	4 × 30	$52	$0.52
Reference cards	100	1 print run	~$50 (estimate)	~$0.50
Total			**~$445**	**~$4.45**

Scaling up: 250 kits run about $1,100, and 500 kits about $2,200. Leftover packs (20 seat liners, extra wipes) roll into the next batch.

> **Open item:** get a real quote for the laminated cards before the pilot order. Ask a local print shop to donate the run in exchange for a logo on the card back.

Funding

Kits are paid for through grants and sponsors, not chapter dues. Pitch it the same way you pitch Hydration Drive sponsors.

Where the money comes from:

- **Main org:** funds the pilot chapters directly.
- **State or local grants:** community health, firefighter safety, and youth-service grants. Chapters search for ones in their own state.
- **Local sponsors:** businesses that already back Hydration Drive or Letters for Lungs, plus hardware stores, print shops, urgent cares, and safety-supply companies.
- **In-kind donations:** ask stores to donate gloves, bags, or the card print run instead of cash.

> ### The sponsor pitch, in four lines
>
> **The problem:** soot and toxins stay on firefighters' skin and gear after a call, and some are linked to cancer.
>
> **The fix:** a pocket-size decon kit they can use on the spot.
>
> **The ask:** $445 equips 100 firefighters. $45 covers a single engine crew of 10.
>
> **What you get:** your logo on the card back, a thank-you post on Project Pulmonary's Instagram, and photos from the delivery.

Keep every receipt, and send the totals to the main org with your report-back (see the checklist).

Assembly

Build kits at a volunteer session, the same way you run Letters for Lungs. You can run both at once: one table writes letters, another packs kits, and a letter goes into every kit.

Before the session:

- Supplies delivered and counted against the order sheet.
- Cards printed and laminated.
- One table per station, 6–8 feet each, plus 2–3 volunteers per station.

Run it as an assembly line:

1. **Station 1 – Fold:** fold contractor bags and seat liners flat.
2. **Station 2 – Pack:** wipes, 2 bags, 2 glove pairs and the liner go into the pouch.
3. **Station 3 – Card and letter:** the reference card goes in face-out so it shows through the pouch, plus a Letters for Lungs note if you have one.
4. **Station 4 – Check and seal:** count items, zip, add a size sticker (M or L), and box in tens.

With 10 volunteers, aim for about 100 kits an hour. The pilot will confirm the real rate. Spot-check 1 in 10 kits at the end.

Wear gloves while packing (new kits shouldn't pick up anything on the way), and take photos for the report-back and for sponsors.

Delivery

Deliver kits the way you deliver hydration donations: contact the station first, then drop off in person.

1. **Pick stations:** start with ones your chapter has already worked with through Hydration Drive or Letters for Lungs.
2. **Contact the captain or station officer:** explain the kit, ask how many personnel are on each shift, and set a drop-off time.
3. **Bring enough for every shift:** one kit per firefighter, plus about 10% extra for restocking.
4. **Hand off in person:** show one opened kit and walk through the card in under two minutes.
5. **Ask where they'll keep them:** on the apparatus or in personal gear bags, not in the living quarters.
6. **Follow up after 4–6 weeks:** ask what got used, what didn't, and whether they want a restock.

Get permission before taking photos at the station, and tag the department only if they agree.

Chapter checklist

Work through this in order. Copy it into your chapter's planning doc and tick items off as you go.

Plan and fund

- ☐ Request to join the program through the main org
- ☐ Pick 1–3 stations and get headcounts per shift
- ☐ Set a kit count (headcount + 10%)
- ☐ Secure funding: main org, a grant, or a sponsor
- ☐ Get a quote for the reference cards

Build

- ☐ Order supplies from the order sheet
- ☐ Count everything on arrival
- ☐ Print and laminate the cards
- ☐ Book a space and volunteers for the assembly session
- ☐ Run the session and box kits in tens

Deliver

- ☐ Confirm drop-off times with each station
- ☐ Deliver in person and demo one kit
- ☐ Follow up after 4–6 weeks

Report back to the main org

Send within two weeks of delivery:

What	Example
Kits built and delivered	120 built, 110 delivered, 10 held for restock
Stations reached	3 stations, 2 departments
Total spent and source	$530, local sponsor grant
Volunteers and hours	12 volunteers, 2 hours
Station feedback	What got used, what didn't, restock requests
Photos and receipts	Shared folder link

Pilot chapters should also note anything that didn't fit, broke, or went unused. That feedback sets the standard kit for everyone else.